Nisarg Patel

Ph.D. candidate

nvpatel@usc.edu Los Angeles, California

Education

PhD — **University of Southern California**, Comparative Studies in Literature and Culture — California, USA, 2021 – present
- Comparative Media and Culture

Master of Arts — **University of Toronto**, Comparative Literature — Ontario, Canada, 2019 – 2020
- GPA 3.97/4.00

Bachelor of Arts (Honors) — **University of Toronto**, English Literature (major), Cinema Studies (minor), Literary Theory and Criticism (minor) — Ontario, Canada, 2016 – 2019
- GPA 3.74/4.00

Bachelor of Arts — **Indira Gandhi Open University**, Philosophy — India, 2013 – 2016
- First Class

Bachelor of Engineering — **Gujarat Technological University**, Production Engineering — Gujarat, India, 2012 – 2016
- GPA 8.14/10.00

Awards

Silver Medal, Outstanding Academic Achievement — 2019
St. Michael's College, University of Toronto

Dr. Michael Lutsky Undergraduate Award in Humanities — 2018-2019
Jackman Humanities Institute, University of Toronto

Dean's List of Scholars — 2016-2019
University of Toronto

Research Award for Outstanding Engineering Project — 2016
Birla Vishwakarma Mahavidyalaya

Conference Presentations

History, Mythology, and the Everyday in Early Indian Cinema: Annual Conference on South Asia, 2026-2027; Symposium organizer, Everyday Practices of Media in India

Dreams, Delirium, and Other Postcolonial Passions: First Forum, USC, 2026-2027

Writing After Amnesia: The Narratives of History between G.N. Devy and Qurratulain Hyder: ACLA Annual Conference, 2025-2026; Seminar Organizer: Uses and Abuses of History in Literary Narratives

To See a World in a Frame of an Image: Stereoscopes and Colonial Life-Worlds [Lebenswelt] of British India: Annual Conference on South Asia, U. Wisconsin-Madison, 2025-2026

Between Two Deaths: The Work of Silence in the Thought of Ranajit Guha and Gayatri Spivak: CSLC Annual Graduate Student Symposium, USC, 2025-2026

Visions of Pasts, Fictions of History: Winter Workshop on Photography, Universität Tübingen, 2024-2025

Witnessing Empire: Stereoscopes and the 1857 Mutiny in British India: Media Fields Journal Biennial IX Conference, 2024-2025

Ancient Myths, Modern Markets: Summer Workshop on South Asian Literature, Universität Tübingen, 2022-2023

Nationalist Ideologies in the Time of Transnational Cinema: CARGC Symposium, University of Pennsylvania, 2022-2023

हमारे अपनो को जगाना है: Bollywood's Histories in the Time of Hindu Nationalism: SAGSC XX, University of Chicago, 2022-2023

After-Images of Pre-Colonial India: NYU Cinema Studies Conference, NYU, 2022-2023

मेरे पास माँ है: Material and Sentimental Excess in Visual Cultures of Post-Colonial India: First Forum, USC, 2021-2022

Hello, Hello, Ji: Networks of Sociality and Commodity in Post-Colonial India: Annual Conference on South Asia, U. Wisconsin-Madison, 2021-2022

Expert Yogis, Impotent Men, Depressed Wives: Social Life of Sexual Tonics in Late Colonial India: CSLC Graduate Symposium, USC, 2021-2022

Making Space, Indulging Fantasies: Studio Photo in Colonial and Post-Colonial India: Annual South Asian Studies Conference, University of Chicago, 2021-2022

Glimpse of an Old Home: On Hermeneutics of Colonial-gaze and the Gaze of Colonial-Hermeneutics: Research-Fellow Presentation, Jackman Humanities Institute, UofT

Fellowships

National Stereoscopic Association Research Fellowship: Library of Congress, 2026-2027

Graduate School Summer Research and Writing Grant: USC, 2026 Summer

Graduate Scholar, Society of Fellows in Humanities: Levan Institute of Humanities, USC, 2025-2026

Teresa Wilson Endowed Fellowship: USC, 2025-2026

VSGC Summer Research Fellowship: VSRI, USC, 2025 Summer

Salz Pollak Pollak Research Fellowship: USC, 2024-2025

VSGC Summer Research Fellowship: VSRI, USC, 2024 Summer

CSLC Summer Research Fellowship,: CSLC, USC, 2024 Summer

NEH/VSRI Images out of Time Graduate Fellow: VSRI, USC, 2023-2024

USC-LACMA Summer Research Fellowship,: VSRI and CSLC, USC, 2023 Summer

PhD Academy Scholarship and Research Fund,: Dornsife PhD Academy, USC, 2022-2026

GSG Professional Development Fund,: Graduate Student Government, USC, 2022-2026

Graduate Research Fellowship,: East Asian Studies, University of Toronto, 2020

Center for Comparative Literature Graduate Program Award,: University of Toronto, 2019-2020

Writers-in-Residence Fellowship for Creative Writing,: Massey College, University of Toronto, 2019-2020

Undergraduate Research Fellowship,: Jackman Humanities Institute, University of Toronto, 2018-2019

Publications

Nationalist Ideologies in the Time of Transnational Cinema: On the Double Life of S.S. Rajamouli's RRR (2022) between India and the World
Nisarg Patel
www.routledge.com/Theorizing-Cinemas-Multiple-Globalizations/Wagner-Jeong-Mazaj/p/book/9781041149811

Dreams, Delirium, and Other Postcolonial Passions
Nisarg Patel
drive.google.com/file/d/1jslEylX_C75lh4TW3amCp6kIH2I2oKtV/view

Ancient Myths, National(ist) Bestsellers
Nisarg Patel
drive.google.com/file/d/1H6LabEyO5Ze4SMC_bjssdMI7QkgJNAbo/view?usp=sharing

Between Two Deaths: The Work of Silence in the Thought of Ranajit Guha and Gayatri Spivak
Nisarg Patel
drive.google.com/file/d/1htLaYEitO5BYO_Z4sIlvQ7DwrJzttkat/view?usp=sharing

The Other Epics of India: Gurram Jashuva's 'Gabbilam' (Book Review)
Nisarg Patel
drive.google.com/file/d/1NdUj49ky0aozsZQolRyyBDaV1nsPckjF/view?usp=sharing

India's Absent Revolution: A Review of Manu Joseph's 'Why the Poor Don't Kill Us' (Book Review)
Nisarg Patel
drive.google.com/file/d/1E3GJmd9QvudRKl7fo5ZK_f3F2LG-CwmW/view?usp=sharing

Frontiers, Sovereignty, and the Politics in/of Trieb (Book Review)
Nisarg Patel
drive.google.com/file/d/1kypVpkq6Nz6EJVR_q4d_tkJEYvjwG4ca/view?usp=sharing

'Seven Poems in Train' by Manglesh Dabral (Translation)
Nisarg Patel
heyzine.com/flip-book/eb91770eb5.htmlpage/146

Manglesh Dabral Translated from Hindi (Translation)
Nisarg Patel
drive.google.com/file/d/1JY69dUyLj0JMA6xLPEWCASYTbBeILlIx/view?usp=sharing

Seven Poems by Manglesh Dabral (Translation)
Nisarg Patel
www.asymptotejournal.com/blog/2025/03/18/translation-tuesday-seven-poems-by-manglesh-dabral

Simple Sorrows: Poems by Manglesh Dabral (Translation)
Nisarg Patel
drive.google.com/drive/folders/1lNOj-zYmAvBNzkJmxfJp4JWAL3SYdKd8?dmr=1&ec=wgc-drive-%5Bmodule%5D-goto

Stories in the Time of Despair: Easterine Kire's 'Spirit Nights'(Book Review)
Nisarg Patel
drive.google.com/file/d/1mbm0hPhLee7QUo5VQrTzAYoHwAQLyCqs/view?usp=sharing

Alienation, Caterogically Speaking (Short Review)
Nisarg Patel
drive.google.com/file/d/1S28yGhvxK5yjXn2kVReeEeKAYHQHvR-3/view?usp=sharing

Teaching Experience

On Location: The Place of Literature in Global Culture: 2023-2024, Teaching Assistant

Introduction to Sociology: 2023-2024, Teaching Assistant

On Location: The Place of Literature in Global Culture: 2022-2023, Teaching Assistant

Cultures of Latin America: 2022-2023, Teaching Assistant

Research Experience

Graduate Research Assistant: Visual Studies Research Institute (USC), 2026-2027

Graduate Summer Research Assistant: Prof. Kimia Shahi (USC), 2024

History of Photography Summer Research: Britt Salvesen (LACMA), 2023

Graduate Summer Research Assistant: Prof. Atsuko Sakaki (University of Toronto), 2020

Editorial Assistant: Prof. Martin Revermann (University of Toronto), 2020

Graduate Research Assistant: Prof. Sara Saljoughi (University of Toronto), 2019-2020

Languages

Hindi
Native speaker

Gujarati
Native speaker

English
Full Proficiency

French
Intermediate Proficiency

Interests

Fields

Certificates

Certificate in Communication, Leadership, and Management 2025

Visual Studies Graduate Certificate 2024

Center for Excellence in Teaching Certificate 2024

Digital Media and Culture Graduate Certificate 2023

Professional Membership

American Comparative Literature Association.: Member since 2023

Society for Cinema and Media Studies: Member since 2023

Modern Language Association.: Member since 2024

Projects

Theory Today 2024 – present

'Theory Today' working group aims primarily to read and discuss the diverse range of trends within contemporary theory. From Psychoanalysis to contemporary interventions within Marxism, Postcolonial thought, Media Theory, and Gender and Sexuality studies, this group engages with recently published monographs and essays from various fields and backgrounds that are actively shaping contemporary theoretical discourse.

References

Professor Neetu Khanna, University of Southern California

Professor Priya Jaikumar, University of Southern California

Professor Panivong Norindr, University of Southern California

Professor Vanessa Schwartz, University of Southern California

Professor Ronald Mendoza-de Jesús, Emory University